# Rytelo (imetelstat)

**Original Effective Date:** 7/15/2024
**Revision Date(s):** 7/15/2024; 11/20/2024; 1/1/2025; 12/19/2025
**Review Date:** 12/19/2025
**Policy type:** Medical Necessity
**Line of Business:** All G.E.H.A Medical Plans

Authorizations are issued for 6 (six) months, unless the ordering physician requests a different timespan or the patients' unique circumstance or condition supports the medical necessity for a different authorization timeframe. Reauthorization requests are reviewed for efficacy, safety and tolerability.

| Preference | Requires Prior Auth | Drug Name | HCPCS Code | Description |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Preferred** | Yes | **Reblozyl (luspatercept)** | **J0896** | Injection, luspatercept-aamt, 0.25 mg |
| Non-Preferred | Yes | **Rytelo (imetelstat)** | **J0870** | Injection, imetelstat, 1 mg |
| • Members must have documentation of a contraindication, failure, or intolerance to any of the preferred agents prior to approval of a non-preferred product, when clinically appropriate.<br>• Preferred product requirements apply to new starts only.<br>• Step Therapy applies to all overlapping compendia supported indications/regimens. | | | | |

## Indication Specific Approval Criteria:

### Myelodysplastic Syndrome (MDS)

- Member is 18 years of age or older; **AND**
- Member's MDS is classified as IPSS low- to intermediate-1 risk; **AND**
- Member's absolute neutrophil count is 1.5 x $10^9$/L or greater within the last 30 days; **AND**
- Member's platelets are 75 x $10^9$/L or greater within the last 30 days; **AND**
- Member has no prior treatment with either lenalidomide OR hypomethylating agents; **AND**
- Member does not have del(5q) cytogenic abnormality**; AND**
- Member is transfusion-dependent requiring 4 or more units of red blood cells in previous 8 weeks; **AND**
- Member has ring sideroblasts (RS) of 15% or more (or 5% or more with SF3B1 mutation); **AND**
    - Member has serum EPO > 500 mU/mL; **OR**
    - Member has serum EPO of 500 or less; **AND**
        - Member has lost response to luspatercept; **OR**
- Member has RS less than 15% (or RS less than 5% with SF3B1 mutation); **AND**
    - Member has serum EPO greater than 500 mU/mL; **AND**
        - Member and no response to immunosuppressive therapy (IST), did not tolerate IST, relapsed after IST or is a poor candidate for IST; **OR**
    - Member has serum EPO of 500 mU/mL or less; **AND**
        - Member has lost response to erythropoietin-stimulating agents (ESAs); **OR**
        - Member has failed to respond to ESA therapy; **OR**